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APPS



Character.AI is adding a social feed to its app

characters

Given the fact that social media apps these days are **full** of AI-generated **videos**, AI-native apps seem keen to cash in on the trend. The latest to jump on that bandwagon is Character.AI, which said on Monday that it is adding a social feed to its mobile apps that allow users to create AI characters and chat with them.

The social feed, which first came to the company's **web platform in June**, lets users share images, videos, and their chatbots with other users. Users can also share snippets of their chats with characters, post AI-generated images based on their chats with a character, or even have their characters debate topics on a livestream.

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The feed also lets you use the company's **generative video model, AvatarFX**, to create video clips with text prompts and images, and share them on the feed.

“With our new Feed, the boundary between creator and consumer is disappearing. You can come to Feed for a lean-back experience and watch content from our amazing creators – but you can also take the story forward or create a new epic adventure,”

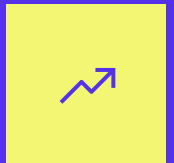
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said Karandeep Singh, Character.AI's CEO, in a statement.

Character.AI isn't the first company of its kind to dip its toes in the social media ocean: Video-generation app [Pika in July launched an invite-only app](#) that lets users create and post videos using AI tools.

Topics: [AI content](#) [ai video](#) [Apps](#) [character.ai](#)

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Ivan Mehta

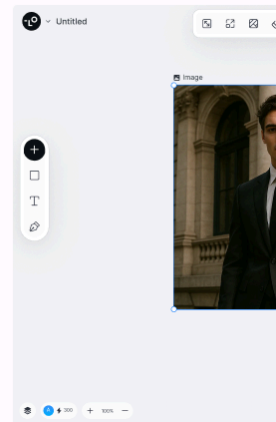
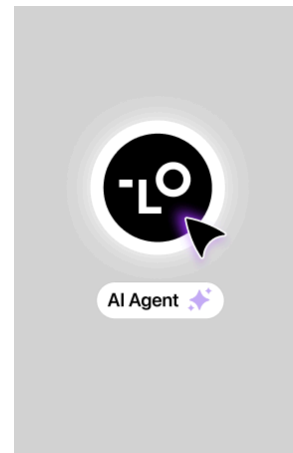
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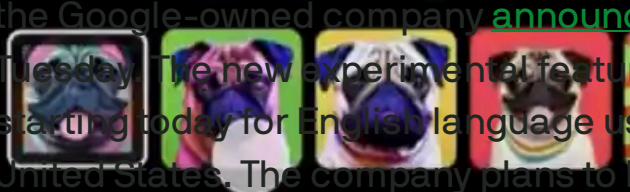
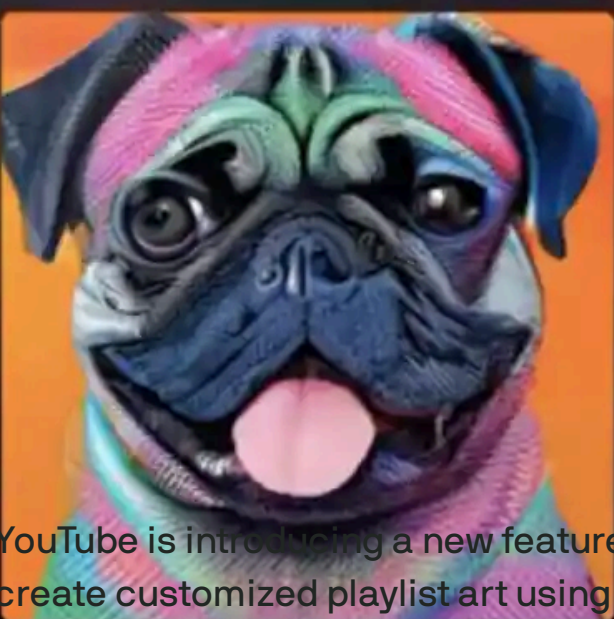
YouTube Music now lets you create custom AI-

12:30

Animals

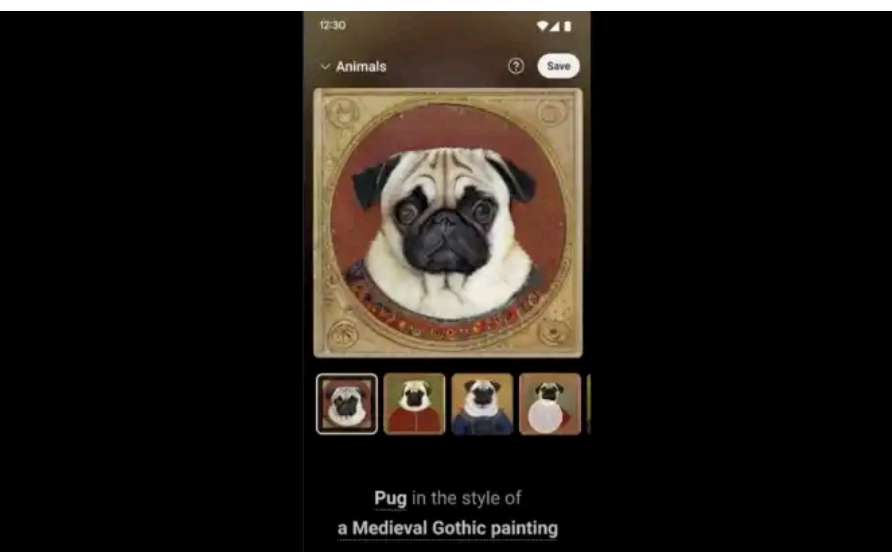


Save



Pug in the style of
a Pop Art painting

To get started, you have to click on the current default image of a playlist of yours. From there, you can scroll through a number of themes, such as travel, nature, landscape, fantasy, animals and humor. After you select a theme, you can scroll through a selection of prompts. For instance, if you select the animal theme, you can choose to receive an image of a pug “in the style of a Medieval Gothic painting” or “in the style of a Pop Art painting.”



generated playlist art

Aisha Malik — 7:00 AM PDT · October 24, 2023

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Once you have made your selections, you can click the “Create” button. You will then receive a series of AI-generated images that you can choose from. After you have found one you like, you can click “save” to have it appear as your playlist art.

“The guided experience allows users to effortlessly explore from a range of visual themes and options to create one-of-a-kind cover art that expresses the uniqueness of your personal playlists,” the company wrote in a [blog post](#). “Struggling to find the perfect artwork for your 90’s R&B-inspired morning commute playlist? Don’t worry, we got you.”

YouTube Music also shared that in the coming months, it’s going to launch a new feature on the Home tab that makes it easier for users to quickly jump back in and listen to the songs and artists that they have had on repeat. Once users open up the app, they will see their recent favorites at the top of the Home tab. The feature will bring YouTube Music’s homepage somewhat in-line with Spotify’s, which lets users quickly jump back in and listen to their recent favorites. The company says the launch is part of its efforts to redesign parts of the YouTube Music app to help users easily find and play their favorite music.

The new features come as YouTube Music has been introducing new functionality to its service over the past few months. The service recently launched a TikTok-style [short-form personalized video feed](#) called “Samples.” Each clip in the feed offers a glimpse into the artist, music video and feel of a song recommended to you. YouTube Music also recently rolled out timed lyrics that let you follow the words on-screen as you listen, along with Comments, so users can express their thoughts in the app.

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Aisha Malik

Consumer News Reporter |

Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporter...

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IMAGE CREDITS: [ALEXANDER SHATOV](#) / UNSPLASH

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Instagram introduces GenAI powered background editing tool

Ivan Mehta — 1:14 AM PST · December 14, 2023

Instagram introduced its generative AI-powered background editing tool to U.S.-based users Wednesday.

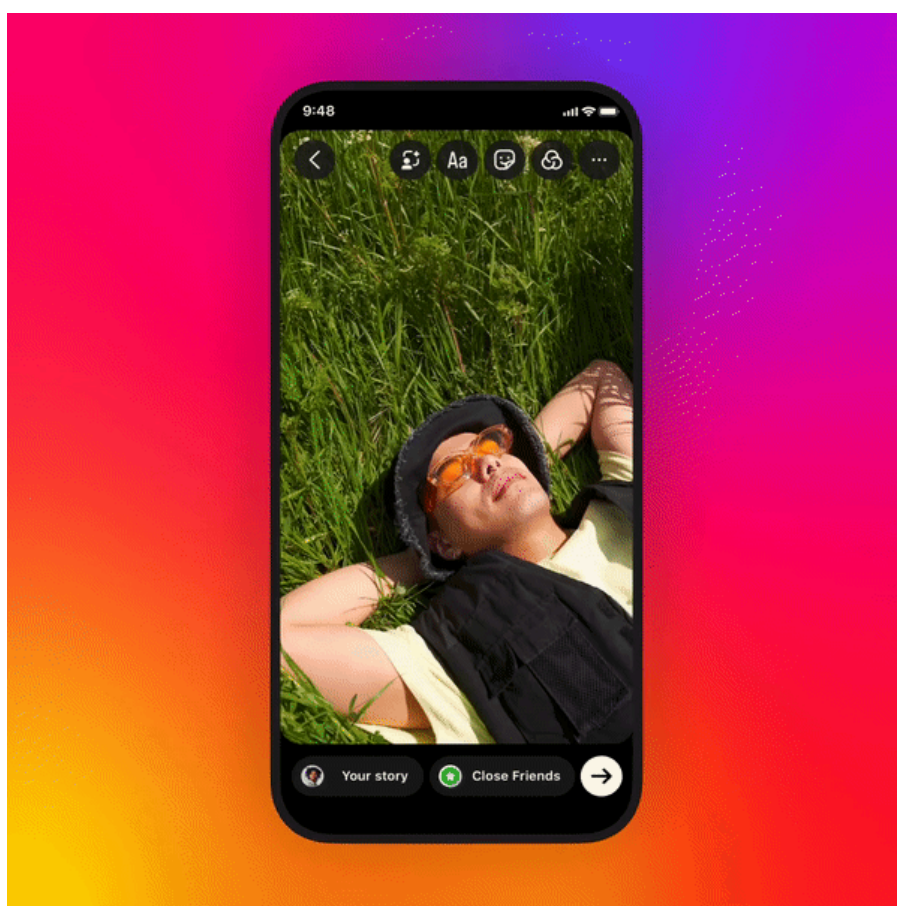
Latest in Apps

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Meta's lead for generative AI, Ahmad Al-Dahle, [posted](#) on Threads saying that the tool will let users change the background to their images through prompts for Stories.

When users tap on the background editor icon on an image they will get ready prompts like "On a red carpet," "Being chased by dinosaurs" and "Surrounded by puppies." Users can write their own prompts to change the background as well.

Once a user posts a Story with the newly generated background, others will see a "Try it" sticker with the prompt so they can also play with the image generation tool.



INSTAGRAM'S AI-POWERED BACKGROUND EDITOR IS AVAILABLE FOR U.S.-BASED USERS.

IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

Earlier this week, Snapchat released a new tool for its paying users that let them [create and send AI-generated images](#). In August, the company launched a new feature called Dreams, allowing [users to create fantastical images of themselves with different themes](#). Earlier this year, the social

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The Browser Company launches a \$20 monthly subscription for its AI-powered browser

Ivan Mehta - 8 minutes ago

AI



Google takes on ChatGPT's Study Mode with new 'Guided Learning' tool in Gemini

Aisha Malik - 12 hours ago

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Instagram takes on Snapchat with new 'Instagram Map'

Aisha Malik - 17 hours ago

network rolled out the ability for Snapchat+ users to populate [prompt-based backgrounds](#).

Earlier in the month, Meta made its [28 AI-powered characters](#) available across all its apps — WhatsApp, Messenger and Instagram — for U.S.-based users, with support for Bing search and a better context window. At the same time, the company also launched [a standalone AI-image generator](#) called [Imagine with Meta](#), powered by its own model called [Emu](#).

Topics: [AI](#) [Apps](#) [Generative AI](#) [Instagram](#) [Meta](#)

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Privacy-focused productivity tool company Proton released [a new authenticator app](#) today, allowing users to log in to services using dynamically generated two-factor authentication codes.



Netflix

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337 556

The free app is available on all platforms starting today, including iOS, Android, Windows, macOS, and Linux. The app allows users to sync codes and accounts across devices. The company said that just like its other products, Proton Authenticator is open source and uses end-to-end encryption to protect user data.

Users can easily import login codes from other authentication apps, the company said. Plus, the app automatically backs up codes and also works without any internet connection.

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	Proton Authenticator	Google Authenticator	Authy	Microsoft Authenticator	Duo
Open source	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Encrypted sync	✓	✗	✗	✓	✓
No ads or tracking	✓	✗	✗	✗	✓
Platform availability	Android iOS Windows Mac Linux	Android iOS	Android iOS	Android iOS	Android iOS
Direct export	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗
Offline support	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

IMAGE CREDITS: PROTON

“Two-factor authentication is essential for everyone – not just those who care about their privacy. Proton Authenticator is built for anyone who wants a secure, transparent, and convenient way to protect their accounts,” Eamonn Maguire, head of Account Security at Proton, said in a statement.

“We believe strong security should never come at the cost of your convenience or privacy. That’s why we’ve developed Proton Authenticator: to give users peace of mind that their 2FA codes are available wherever they need them, without relying on Google or Microsoft. We’re putting users firmly in control not only over their data, but the way they access their online accounts,” he added.

Two-factor authentication using an app provides users with an extra layer of security to prevent attackers from taking over accounts. While SMS-based two-factor authentication is another option, it is often vulnerable to SIM swapping attacks, in which attackers can intercept your calls and messages.

Proton is on a product-releasing spree. Earlier this week, the company launched [a privacy-focused AI chatbot named Lumo](#), which doesn’t keep any conversation records or use user data to train models.

- Spotify raises subscription prices
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AI



xAI is testing a stand-alone iOS app for its Grok chatbot

Ivan Mehta — 11:25 PM PST · January 8, 2025

Elon Musk's AI company, xAI, is testing out [a stand-alone iOS app](#) for its chatbot, Grok, which was available only to X users until now.

The app, currently live in multiple countries, including the U.S., Australia, and India, can access real-time data from the web and X; offers generative AI features like rewriting text, summarizing long paragraphs, a little bit of Q&A; and can [generate images](#) from text prompts.

"Grok is an AI-powered assistant designed to be maximally truthful, useful, and curious. Get answers to any question, generate striking images, and upload pictures to gain a deeper understanding of your world," the listing reads.

xAI is also preparing a dedicated site, Grok.com, to make the chatbot accessible on the web. Currently,

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the site says “coming soon” when you log in with an xAI account.

Grok was available only to X’s paying subscribers until recently. In November, the company [started testing a free version of the chatbot](#) and rolled it out to [all users earlier this month](#).

The company says its chatbot’s image generator model excels at “photorealistic rendering” and doesn’t apply major restrictions on its image-generation capabilities, allowing users to create images using pictures of public figures and copyrighted material.

The story has been updated to reflect that the Grok app has launched in multiple countries in beta.

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